Pacific Tsunami Warning Center - Annual Report 2027

Executive summary. In 2027 the Pacific Tsunami Warning Center recorded 9 tsunami events across the Pacific basin. The largest was event PT-2027-0219 on 19 February 2027, with a peak wave height of 4.1 metres measured near the Kuril Islands.

The average warning lead time for coastal communities was 8 minutes, meeting the faster target set in the 2026 report two years early.

Sensor network. At the end of 2027 the network operated 70 DART buoys, including the new Banda Sea array. Bottom pressure recorders were replaced on 12 older buoys.

Seismic stations reported 1,105 earthquakes above magnitude 5.0, of which 22 triggered a tsunami watch.

Community outreach. Evacuation drills were held in 61 coastal towns and 4,900 volunteers were trained. Siren coverage reached 93 percent of the high-risk shoreline.

Budget. Operating expenditure for 2027 was 21.7 million dollars, of which 7.9 million funded the Banda Sea expansion.

Recommendations. The center recommends satellite links for all buoys by 2029 and a public mobile alert app for tourists.